Doug Vargas

Head of Product · Design Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Head of Product and design systems lead with 12 years in digital product design. I lead product at Naowee, the platform for Colombia's sports system, and build working prototypes in code with AI. Before that I was Tech Lead on Andes, Mercadolibre's design system across 18 countries, and for 5 years and 2 months Design System Gatekeeper at Banco de Occidente.

`18 countries - 400+ designers - 2,000+ engineers - 12+ squads - 130+ screens`

WORK EXPERIENCE

Head of Product

Naowee – Barranquilla, Colombia (Remote) | `01/2026 - Present`

- Lead SUID, the platform for Colombia's sports system, with a team of 2: 8 business modules, including inspection and oversight of ~1,200 sports organizations and their 30 regulatory procedures.
- Built the product's design system: 38+ components, a canonical shell and a single wizard recipe that keeps 130+ screens in one language.
- Modeled the sector's real hierarchy (committees, federations, leagues, clubs and athletes) with cascading approval across 45+ states and 15 roles.
- Replaced specs with working prototypes in code, built with AI, that analysts sign off story by story against the running product.

Tech Lead · Design Systems

Mercadolibre (Andes Design System) – LATAM (Remote) | `01/2024 - 01/2026`

- Technical lead on Andes, the design system behind Mercadolibre's commerce, fintech and shipping products across 18 countries.
- Maintained the component library for iOS, Android and Web, used by 400+ designers and 2,000+ engineers.
- Defined the system's foundations (design tokens, spacing, type and motion) that govern the whole product suite.
- Agreed single component APIs with engineering across platforms and introduced AI-driven audits that catch system drift in Figma before it ships.

Senior Product Designer · Design System Gatekeeper

Aval Digital Labs (Banco de Occidente) – Bogotá, Colombia (Hybrid) | `11/2018 - 01/2024`

- Governed additions, deprecations and patterns of the design system shared by the bank's 12+ product squads.
- Built Velocity, the bank's design system: documentation, foundations and a component library on atomic-design principles.
- Redesigned the core digital-banking flows (login and registration, accounts and cards, transfers and payments) for desktop, tablet and mobile.
- Mentored junior and mid-level designers and led workshops, classes and design critiques.

Senior Product Designer

Globant (Royal Caribbean) – Medellín, Colombia (On-site) | `08/2017 - 11/2018`

- Designed the mobile and web booking and onboard flows: destinations, stateroom types and life aboard.
- Designed schedules, dining, excursions and balances to hold up on intermittent connectivity at sea.

- Worked with cross-functional product and engineering teams in the United States.

Lead UI Designer

Ideaware (Qrvey) – Barranquilla, Colombia (On-site) | 10/2016 - 08/2017

- Promoted to lead UI on Qrvey, a survey and NPS platform: defined its visual language across mobile and web.
- Designed AutomatiQ end to end, the automation builder (processes, triggers, conditions and actions), and prototyped UX/UI improvements that shipped.

Senior UX/UI Designer

Ideaware – Barranquilla, Colombia (On-site) | 03/2016 - 10/2016

- Delivered developer-ready wireframes, UI kits and prototypes for web and mobile to international clients.
- Designed Pool Botball, an iOS app for monitoring pool chemistry.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Junior UI Designer

Smartbiz Solutions – Barranquilla, Colombia (On-site) | 10/2014 - 02/2016

First UI role. Interface design for web and mobile client projects, and the first time I worked inside a shared component library instead of one-off screens.

Graphic & Interface Designer

Freelance – Barranquilla, Colombia (On-site) | 02/2010 - 10/2014

Independent graphic and interface design for local clients — brand systems, print and early web work.

SKILLS

Product: Product direction, Design thinking, User research, Customer journeys, User flows, A/B testing, Wireframing, Prototyping.

Design systems: Design tokens, Foundations, Component libraries, Governance, Documentation, Atomic design, iOS, Android and Web parity.

Engineering: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Automated testing, PWA, IndexedDB, Content Security Policy, Git.

Applied AI: Prototyping in code with AI, Generative UI, LLM flows, Prompt-driven design audits, Tool calling.

Leadership: Mentoring, Design workshops and critiques, Cross-functional teams, Stakeholder sign-off, Collaboration with US teams.

Tools: Figma, Webflow, Illustrator, Photoshop, Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub, Storybook, Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Midjourney, Jira, Notion.

EDUCATION

Professional Graphic Designer – Universidad Autónoma del Caribe, Barranquilla, Colombia 2006 - 2009

CERTIFICATIONS

Introduction to UI – Coursera 2022

Design System Essentials – Aval Digital Labs 2020

Design Foundations – Globant 2018

LANGUAGES

Spanish: Native. **English:** B1 · Working proficiency.